

The Tool Picker

Three questions, two seconds, and you stop opening the wrong thing.

THREE KINDS OF WORK

KIND	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	REACH FOR
Asking	A question. You want an answer, not a change.	A chat window
Building	Real files need to change. More than one.	Claude Code
Repeating	The same thing, on a schedule, without you.	A saved job

THE THREE QUESTIONS, IN ORDER

- **Does anything on my disk need to change?** If no, use a chat window and stop here.
- **Will I want this again next week?** If yes, it should be a saved job.
- **Does it need to happen without me there?** If yes, that is an unattended run.

LET IT SORT YOUR OWN LIST

Write five things you actually did last week, then ask

For each of these five things, tell me: is it asking, building, or repeating? Then tell me which one would save me the most time if I automated it, and why. Be blunt if some of them are not worth it.

THE RULE, IN ONE LINE

Stop at the first yes. Most people never get past question one, and that is the correct answer more often than it feels.

THE TWO MISTAKES

Heavy tool, light job

Opening a terminal and waiting, to ask something you could have typed into a chat box. Nothing breaks. You are just slower every day for a year.

Light tool, heavy job

Copying file after file into a chat window and pasting answers back by hand. Twelve copy and pastes is not just slow, it is where the mistakes come from.

WHAT EACH ONE IS GENUINELY BEST AT

TOOL	BEST AT
A chat window	One question, no change to your files
Claude Code	Work across many files, on your real disk
A saved job	The same shape of work, again and again
An unattended run	Work that must happen with nobody watching